Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Maesllewellyn

Maes Llewelyn Residential Home, Church Lane, Newcastle Emlyn, SA38 9AB

01239711990

www.carmarthenshire.gov.wales

The inspection visits for this service took place between 15/09/2026 and 24/09/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Carmarthenshire County Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care
Registered places:	40
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Maes Llewelyn Residential Care Home, in Newcastle Emlyn, provides care and accommodation for up to 40 people across five units.

Well-being is “Good” as people have control over daily life and receive respectful support to maintain their health, relationships and interests.

Care and Support is “Good” as care staff know people well and provide consistent, person-centred care. Effective safeguarding and risk-management systems help people feel safe and protect their rights.

The Environment is “Good” as people live in comfortable, personalised accommodation that promotes privacy, independence and social contact.

Leadership and Management is “Good” as Leaders promote an open culture, support care staff effectively and use strong governance and feedback systems to improve the service.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People maintain and improve their physical, mental and emotional health because care staff provide good-quality care and support. We saw people enjoying chair exercises, ball games, music therapy and garden walks. Care staff encourage people to share hobbies, spend time together and build friendships, creating a strong sense of community. They helped a person who had recently moved into the service to settle and develop a friendship. The visible manager promotes an open, positive culture. People, representatives, care staff and visiting professionals spoke positively about the service. Well-trained care staff know people well and use detailed personal plans and risk assessments to guide person-centred support. The manager and dementia champions support good dementia care. The service also works effectively with health and social care professionals.

Care staff treat people with dignity and respect and support them to enjoy living at Maes Llewelyn. They encourage friendships, shared hobbies and mutual support. Managers remain accessible, while care staff listen, provide clear information and help people make informed choices. The provider makes key information, including its complaints process, available in Welsh. People and their representatives told us they take part in decisions that affect them, and we saw care staff act on their views. We heard care staff and people speaking Welsh. Care staff enter the reality of people living with dementia and respond without judgement. These practices help people feel valued and included.

The provider's systems help care staff identify and address risks promptly. Safeguarding and whistleblowing policies guide care staff in protecting people from abuse and neglect. The management team audits the environment, care practices and medication, with oversight from the Responsible Individual (RI). The maintenance team completes regular fire safety, infection control and water temperature checks. Individual and environmental risk assessments identify hazards and appropriate controls. These arrangements help care staff keep people safe.

People live in accommodation that meets their needs and enhances their quality of life. They personalise their bedrooms, while welcoming communal spaces support social contact and privacy. Dementia-friendly features, including memory boxes and colour-coded tableware, help people orientate themselves and take part in meaningful activity. People said they are happy living at the service. Relatives and visiting professionals also praised the environment and support. The provider uses comprehensive health and safety systems to maintain a safe, comfortable home.

Care & Support — Good

Care staff know people well and consistently provide good-quality care and support. A core team has worked at the service for many years. We saw skilled care staff use their knowledge of people's individual needs and preferences to provide person-centred support. The experienced and caring management team supports care staff well and promotes a positive culture. We found care staff placing great importance on ensuring people recently moved into the home are put at ease and encouraged to develop friendships with others. This people told us had made a significant difference to their lives.

Care staff support people to follow their preferred routines and daily structure. We saw care staff respond flexibly to people's needs and choices about how they wished to spend their day. The service is calm and welcoming, and we saw many positive interactions between people and care staff. People and their representatives spoke positively about managers and care staff. Representatives said, *"the staff are warm and friendly"* and *"I feel this home is an extension of my family".* People said, *"the staff are wonderful and so kind"* and *"the manager will do anything for us".*

People's personal plans tell care staff how to support them to live well at the service. The provider gathers useful information from professionals and others involved in people's care and support. The plans record people's preferences, routines, interests, life histories and important relationships. They use positive language and give care staff clear guidance about how each person wishes to receive support. The provider reviews personal plans regularly. However, the reviews do not always show people's progress towards their outcomes or how people and their representatives contribute to the process.

The provider protects people from harm and abuse. Open communication promotes a strong safeguarding culture. Care staff receive appropriate training and follow clear policies and procedures. We found the provider protects people's liberty in line with legislation and current practice. Detailed individual and environmental risk assessments help care staff keep people safe.

Care staff manage people's medicines safely and understand each person's prescribed treatment. Relevant training, regular practice audits and a clear medication policy support staff. Recent internal and external audits found that care staff follow safe and consistent practices. Care staff organise and store medicines in line with requirements, which protects their safety and effectiveness.

Environment — Good

People can choose from a range of communal and private spaces where they can spend time alone, socialise or entertain visitors. The service comprises five smaller units, each with comfortable lounge and dining areas. One unit specialises in supporting people living with dementia. Where needed, people had personalised memory boxes outside their bedrooms to help them find their rooms. Bedroom doors also displayed people's names clearly. Communal spaces support people's independence and provide opportunities for private meetings, activities and recreation. An additional sun and garden room offers a pleasant space for activities and family gatherings.

We saw people enjoying the pleasant, enclosed and accessible gardens. One person said, *"I love sitting in the garden listening to the birds".* Artwork and photographs of the local area displayed in communal corridors may help prompt people's memories. We saw clean, well-presented and personalised bedrooms. The service provider supplies suitable furnishings and equipment to meet people's needs, including specialist beds, call systems, moving and handling equipment, and access to communication facilities. The design of bathrooms, showers and toilets promotes privacy, dignity, safety and accessibility. These features help people feel comfortable and at home.

The service provider identifies and manages risks to people. We found detailed individual and environmental risk assessments, supported by regular audits and reviews of records. Regular servicing and maintenance, together with prompt repairs, help keep people safe and well. A dedicated, experienced on-site maintenance officer keeps the premises in good condition and maintains well-organised records.

The service provider ensures the premises meet current health and safety and environmental health legislation, national guidance, and relevant Food Standards Agency standards. We saw evidence that the Fire Service and external fire safety consultants had inspected the premises. The provider has completed most actions and has plans in place to address the few that remain. Most personal emergency evacuation plans (PEEPs) were up to date, and the manager was updating the small number that remained outstanding.

Leadership & Management — Good

People achieve consistently good outcomes because the provider ensures care staff have the skills, knowledge and support to meet their needs. The provider has effective recruitment and induction processes in place. An experienced, long-standing core staff team mentors and guides less experienced care staff. We saw care staff go the extra mile to cover current vacancies and staff absences. Line managers support staff through one-to-one supervision sessions. These sessions take place at least quarterly, alongside an annual review. Care staff receive relevant training that reflects the care needs of the people they support.

People have high levels of confidence in the provider because leaders promote a positive, supportive, inclusive and respectful culture. We found the manager approachable and accessible and saw them regularly supporting people and care staff on the floor. The manager operates an open-door policy, which helps people, representatives, visitors and professionals feel comfortable raising concerns and confident that leaders will address them appropriately. The manager told us the RI supports them well and visits the service regularly. People, care staff, relatives and visiting professionals gave very positive feedback. Relatives told us, *"Staff here are all lovely"* and *"it's amazing here".* People said, *"It doesn't matter what you want, they get it for you"* and *"the manager is so caring".*

The provider uses effective quality-monitoring systems to maintain high standards of care. We saw leaders act as visible role models and involve people, care staff and visiting professionals in quality assurance processes. Leaders value feedback and use it to drive continuous improvement. The provider has robust, well-embedded governance arrangements. The RI completes comprehensive quarterly and six-monthly reports with support from the internal quality assurance team. The provider has a clear, relevant complaints policy that people can access easily. People, representatives and professionals told us they feel confident giving feedback or raising concerns because leaders welcome and respond to them in a spirit of partnership.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

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